Josh Beard

Platform Engineering | Developer Experience | DevOps

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Staff DevOps engineer focused on platform engineering and developer experience. I build internal tools, CI/CD systems, and automation that scale teams while maintaining governance. Open-source contributor with expertise in Go, AWS, and infrastructure as code.

Experience

Staff DevOps Engineer at Live Oak Bank

September 2022 - Present

- Build internal tools and workflows that improve developer experience and software delivery across multiple teams.
- Architect CI/CD pipelines optimizing deployment speed and reliability.
- Developed open-source Terraform provider and Go API client for third-party integrations.
- Built release orchestration tool in Go that significantly improved release safety and automation.
- Established observability and monitoring for scalable CI/CD processes.

Key technology: *AWS, CI/CD, DataDog, Devcontainers, Docker, GitLab, GitOps, Go, Golang, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions, Platform Engineering, Python, Shell, Terraform, Traefik*

Lead DevSecOps Engineer at Ventera, Inc (US Geological Survey)

June 2022 - April 2023

- Contracted to USGS Water Resources Mission Area to modernize critical water data services.
- Built AWS infrastructure and CI/CD pipelines for serverless Python applications and static websites.
- Automated security checks and code analysis in CI/CD pipelines, streamlining compliance for development teams.

Key technology: *AWS, CloudFormation, GitLab, Python*

Lead DevOps Engineer at Apogee Engineering, LLC (US Geological Survey)

September 2015 - May 2022

- Managed architecture and infrastructure for dozens of USGS products, ensuring scalability and reliability.

- Led migration of hundreds of projects from legacy CI/CD systems to GitLab, improving efficiency and developer experience.
- Deployed configuration management at scale using Puppet and Ansible across hundreds of Linux systems.
- Migrated dozens of applications from on-premise to AWS with Docker, enabling flexible and scalable deployments.
- Mentored teams in DevOps practices and empowered them to manage their own infrastructure with Docker, AWS, and Terraform.

Key technology: *AWS, CI/CD, GitLab, Docker, Terraform, Ansible, Platform Engineering, GitOps, Puppet, Python, Nginx, Traefik*

Professional Services Engineer at Puppet Inc.

September 2013 - April 2015

- Delivered consulting and training on Puppet and DevOps practices to enterprise clients, tailoring solutions to unique needs.
- Created reusable Puppet modules and tools to streamline automation.
- Earned high marks for customer engagement and technical problem-solving across diverse client base.

Key technology: *Puppet, Linux, Ruby, Git, Shell*

Linux/Unix Systems Administrator at Douglas School District

January 2010 - September 2013

- Managed Linux/Unix infrastructure and server operations for K-12 environment.
- Implemented system automation and monitoring solutions.
- Provided technical support and maintained network services.

Key technology: *Linux, Unix, Puppet, Nginx, MySQL, KVM, PHP*

Skills & Expertise

Core Competencies

- Platform Engineering & Developer Experience
- Release Management & Automation
- CI/CD Architecture & Pipeline Design
- Infrastructure as Code & Configuration Management
- DevSecOps & Compliance Automation
- Technical Leadership & Team Enablement

Infrastructure & CI/CD

- GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions
- Terraform, CloudFormation, CDK
- Puppet, Ansible
- Nginx, HAProxy, Traefik
- PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis

Observability

- DataDog, Prometheus
- Elasticsearch, Graylog
- PagerDuty
- Sensu

Platforms & Technologies

- AWS Cloud Services
- Docker, Kubernetes
- Linux/Unix (RHEL, Ubuntu, Debian, Alpine, FreeBSD)
- Virtualization (Proxmox, LXC, Vagrant, KVM, vSphere)
- Security Scanning & Vulnerability Management

Programming Languages

- Go
- Python
- Shell/Bash
- Ruby
- YAML, JSON, HCL
- PHP

Security & Compliance

- Code Analysis & Security Scanning
- Compliance Automation
- Security Policy as Code